

RUIQI JIN

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DOCTORAL RESEARCH FOCUS

My doctoral research investigates how visual and spatial design functions as a mechanism for constructing cultural authority within contemporary art institutions. Drawing from my work in museum curation and community-based art practice, I am particularly interested in: the role of exhibition design in shaping audience perception and constructing meaning; the politics of representation and the gaze in luxury and fashion systems; how multisensory experience operates within institutional contexts; and the critical potential of art in social engagement and institutional critique.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Curatorial Assistant, Intangible Heritage Exhibition, Suzhou Museum *Dec 2023 – Jun 2024*

- Researched and developed exhibition strategies for presenting intangible heritage; analyzed how display design, artifact selection, and curatorial narratives shape visitor understanding and engagement
- Collaborated across museum departments and contributed to exhibition programming and public engagement initiatives

Art Project Director, Chengdu Digital Nomad Community *Jul 2024 – Present*

- Lead research and curation of land art projects; conduct site-specific research and develop implementation frameworks
- Coordinate with artists and cultural practitioners; curate exhibitions, artist talks, and workshops; build collaborative networks
- Develop community cultural programming and foster critical discourse on contemporary artistic practice

EDUCATION

M.A., Creative Industry Management & Marketing **Paris-Kedge Business School** (2024–2026)

Relevant coursework: Art Criticism and Cultural Theory, Museum Studies, Curatorial Practice, Art Writing Seminar, Contemporary Art and Institutional Critique

B.A., Art and Design Management & Marketing (Honor Thesis) **Central Academy of Fine Arts (CAFA)**, GPA: 3.8/4.0 (2020–2024)

Relevant coursework: Chinese Art History, Western Art History (Modern and Contemporary), Museum and Exhibition Studies, Art Criticism and Writing, Visual Culture Theory, Contemporary Curatorial Practice, Art Theory Seminar

Honors: Outstanding Honor Thesis, Second-class Scholarship, Outstanding Graduate (Top 10%), Outstanding Graduate Work

THESIS & RESEARCH

Undergraduate Honor Thesis: "The Flowing Senses: Multisensory Exhibition Design and Audience Experience" (2024)

Explored how sensory dimensions of exhibition design — spatial arrangement, lighting, materials, sound — shape how visitors experience and interpret artworks. Examined the relationship between bodily experience and aesthetic meaning-making in museum contexts. This research synthesized concepts from museum theory, visual culture studies, and phenomenology.

Master Thesis: "To See and to Be Seen: Visual Mechanisms and the Construction of Cultural Authority in Haute Couture" (2026)

Examines how fashion shows function as sites where cultural authority is produced and contested. Through case studies of Valentino, Avavav, and Miu Miu, I analyze how spatial arrangement, model bodies, and viewing structures create hierarchies of power and legitimacy. The research draws on visual culture theory, cultural sociology, and my own experiences working as both model and exhibition curator. This work engages with theories of scopic regimes, institutional critique, and the politics of representation.

ACADEMIC & CREATIVE ENGAGEMENT

Founder & President, CAFA Creative Society – Organized large-scale cultural events for campus community; developed curatorial frameworks for programming

Exhibition Curator – Designed experimental exhibition centered on multisensory experience; developed curatorial concept, spatial design, and accompanying theoretical writing

LANGUAGES & SKILLS

Languages: English (Fluent), Mandarin Chinese (Native)

Research Methods: Qualitative research, exhibition analysis, visual culture studies, curatorial practice, institutional critique, art criticism and writing

Technical Skills: Microsoft Office, Adobe Creative Suite, Claude code